



Jasper Milton Preston Muddock

1888 – 1917

Civilian Research

		Source of data
Casualty Name	J Muddock JMP on CWGC Jasper Milton Preston Muddock	School plaque CWGC Various newspaper reports – see below
Date of Birth	25/5/1888 (along with Horace his twin brother) Forfar, Scotland	Find a Grave https://www.findagrave.com/memorial/25273654/jasper-milton-preston-muddock and https://tinyurl.com/4yd4z8y6
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	30/11/1917 In Palestine	CWGC Newspaper reports
Age at death (from Spreadsheet)	29	Obituary see below

Marital Status	No mention of a wife	
Children (if any)		
Occupation prior to Call up	Working for Bulloch Brothers & Co in Burma where he had been for 5 ½ years. He was attached to Rangoon Mounted Rifles during this time, and was in the Middlesex Sharpshooters prior to leaving England for Burma.	Obituary see below There's more in the obit
Parents	Mr J E Preston Muddock well known as author Dick Donovan, a novelist. His wife: Eleanor Muddock (nee Rudd)	Obituaries – see below https://tinyurl.com/4yd4z8y6 and in War Pension record (below)
Listed Address(s)		
Parents /Fathers occupation	Author in his own name and under the pseudonym Dick Donovan	Various newspaper reports
Brothers and Sisters	2 brothers already killed in action and sisters (not sure how many yet) Brothers killed/died: - Edward Reginald Preston Muddock, KiA in France 4/9/1916, aged 30 - Horace Lionel Preston Muddock, died in Charring Cross Hospital of appendicitis 21/11/1914 aged 27 Sisters: Violette, Ruth, Eleanor	Letter from his father to the Globe (see below) I got their details from the family gravestone in Putney Vale Cemetery – link below to image https://www.cwgc.org/find-records/find-war-dead/casualty-details/196232/edward-reginald-preston-muddock/ He may not have died in war? Can't find him on CWGC and grave doesn't say KiA. But newspapers say all killed in war.... He was the twin brother of Jasper 1911 census living in Wandsworth, Horace was living there too
Years at John Lyon School		
Obituary	See newspapers below – note not in local newspapers as it appears the family didn't live in Harrow	
Additional sources of data		
War Memorials:	John Lyon School, plaque	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11204

	John Lyon School, sundial	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11318
	Dunstable Grammar School – Has all 3 Muddock brother listed	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/185434
	Gravestone for all three (not CWGC) at family grave, Putney Vale Cemetery	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/1472998
	Lives of the First World War	https://livesofthefirstworldwar.iwm.org.uk/lifestory/3156551
Other info:	In 1901 all 3 boys were at Dunstable Grammar School	1901 census

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	MUDDOCK J.M.P.
CWGC Reference	https://www.cwgc.org/find-records/find-war-dead/casualty-details/647683/j-m-p-muddock/
Age	
DoD	30-Nov-17
Rank	2 Lt
Regiment	Shropshire Yeomanry
Location	JERUSALEM WAR CEMETERY -Israel and Palestine (including Gaza)
Military details	Second Lieutenant Jasper Milton Preston Muddock of the Shropshire Yeomanry (attached to the 10th Battalion, King's Shropshire Light Infantry) was killed in action on November 30, 1917, at the age of 29. He was killed in Palestine (modern-day West Bank/Israel) during the Egyptian Expeditionary Force's Sinia and Palestine Campaign. Specifically, his death occurred in the rocky hills surrounding the village of Et Tireh (near Ramallah), just north of Jerusalem. Second Lieutenant Muddock was killed in action during a fierce Turkish counter-attack. The Shropshire Yeomanry had been dismounted and absorbed into the 10th Battalion, King's Shropshire Light Infantry (KSLI), serving under the 74th (Yeomanry) Division. On the night of November 29, 1917, Muddock's unit marched out in the dark to occupy the strategic outpost of Et Tireh. On November 30, Ottoman forces launched a violent, determined counter-offensive to halt the British advance toward Jerusalem. Cut off and facing overwhelming numbers, the unit's commanding officer ordered a fighting retirement. Serving as the battalion's Scout Officer, 2nd Lt. Muddock was caught in the heavy exchange of gunfire and killed instantly on the battlefield alongside two fellow officers. His actions helped extricate the small British force and protect their wounded. He is buried at the Jerusalem War Cemetery (Plot E, Grave 60). Jasper was the son of James Edward Preston Muddock (who wrote under the pen name Dick Donovan), a highly celebrated Victorian author of nearly 300 mystery and detective stories whose popularity at the time rivaled Arthur Conan Doyle. The family suffered immense grief during the war; Jasper's twin brother, Edward Reginald Preston Muddock, had been killed in action a year earlier on September 4, 1916, while fighting in France with the Canadian Infantry. Both brothers are remembered together on a family memorial plot at Putney Vale Cemetery in London

Story of Sacrifice

Jasper Milton Preston Muddock (1888–1917)

Jasper Milton Preston Muddock's life took him from his education at the Lower School of John Lyon, Harrow, to almost six years working in Burma before the First World War brought him into military service. Jasper was the son of celebrated novelist James Edward Preston Muddock, "Dick Donovan", whose three sons all died during the war years.

Civilian Life

Jasper Milton Preston Muddock was born on 25 May 1888 at Forfar, Scotland, the son of James Edward Preston Muddock and Eleanor Muddock. His father was the well-known novelist who wrote both under his own name and under the pseudonym "Dick Donovan", under which he became particularly popular for his detective stories. Jasper was educated at Dunstable Grammar School and the Lower School of John Lyon, Harrow. All three Muddock brothers were recorded at Dunstable Grammar School in 1901, and Jasper's connection with John Lyon is commemorated on the school's First World War memorials. After leaving school, Jasper spent almost six years in Burma, where he worked for Bulloch Brothers & Co. for five and a half years. During his time there he was attached to the Rangoon Mounted Rifles. He developed an interest in Burma and the Burmese and was reported to speak Hindustani, Bengali and Persian. Before leaving England for Burma, he had also been associated with the 3rd Middlesex Sharpshooters.

Military Life

Jasper returned to England in the spring of 1915 following the outbreak of the First World War. He entered the Inns of Court Officers' Training Corps and was commissioned as a Second Lieutenant on 18 August 1915, joining the Shropshire Yeomanry. His regiment sailed for Egypt in March 1916, where it undertook duties connected with the defence of the Suez Canal. Following reorganisation in 1917, Jasper became part of the 74th (Yeomanry) Division and saw active service during the Second Battle of Gaza in April 1917. He was promoted to Lieutenant in July and subsequently took part in the Third Battle of Gaza and the operations leading to the capture of Jerusalem.

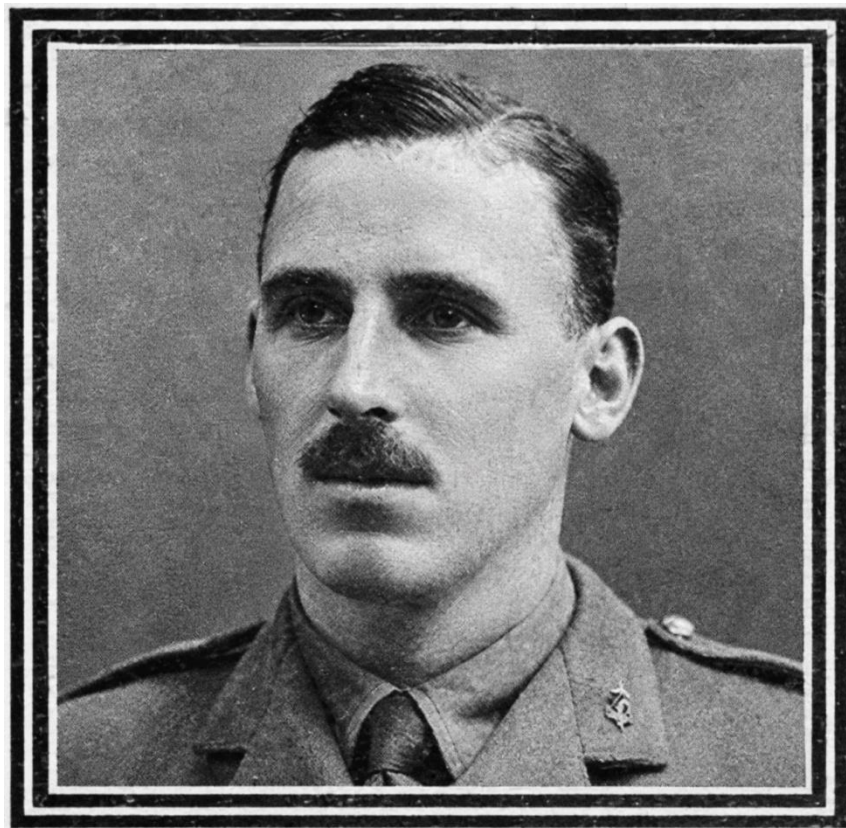
Muddock was killed in Palestine (modern-day West Bank/Israel) during the Egyptian Expeditionary Force's Sinai and Palestine Campaign. Specifically, his death occurred in the rocky hills surrounding the village of Et Tireh (near Ramallah), just north of Jerusalem. Second Lieutenant Muddock was killed in action during a fierce Turkish counter-attack. The Shropshire Yeomanry had been dismounted and absorbed into the 10th Battalion, King's Shropshire Light Infantry (KSLI), serving under the 74th (Yeomanry) Division. On the night of November 29, 1917, Muddock's unit marched out in the dark to occupy the strategic outpost of Et Tireh. On November 30, Ottoman forces launched a violent, determined counter offensive to halt the British advance toward Jerusalem. Cut off and facing overwhelming numbers, the unit's commanding officer ordered a fighting retirement. Serving as the battalion's Scout Officer, Lt. Muddock was caught in the heavy exchange of gunfire and killed instantly on the battlefield alongside two fellow officers. His actions helped extricate the small British force and protect their wounded. He is buried at the Jerusalem War Cemetery (Plot E, Grave 60).

A Family of Three Wartime Deaths

Jasper was the last surviving son of James Edward Preston Muddock and Eleanor Muddock. His twin brother, Horace Lionel Preston Muddock, had died at Charing Cross Hospital on 21 November 1914, aged 27, from appendicitis. His other brother, Edward Reginald Preston Muddock, was killed in action in France on 4 September 1916, aged 30, while serving with the Canadian Infantry.

Jasper's death in Palestine in November 1917 therefore meant that his parents had lost all three of their sons during the First World War years. The loss was reported in contemporary newspapers, which described Jasper as the last surviving son of the novelist J. E. Preston Muddock, "Dick Donovan." The family's three sons are commemorated together on the family grave at Putney Vale Cemetery, while Jasper is also remembered on the John Lyon School First World War memorial.

Photos



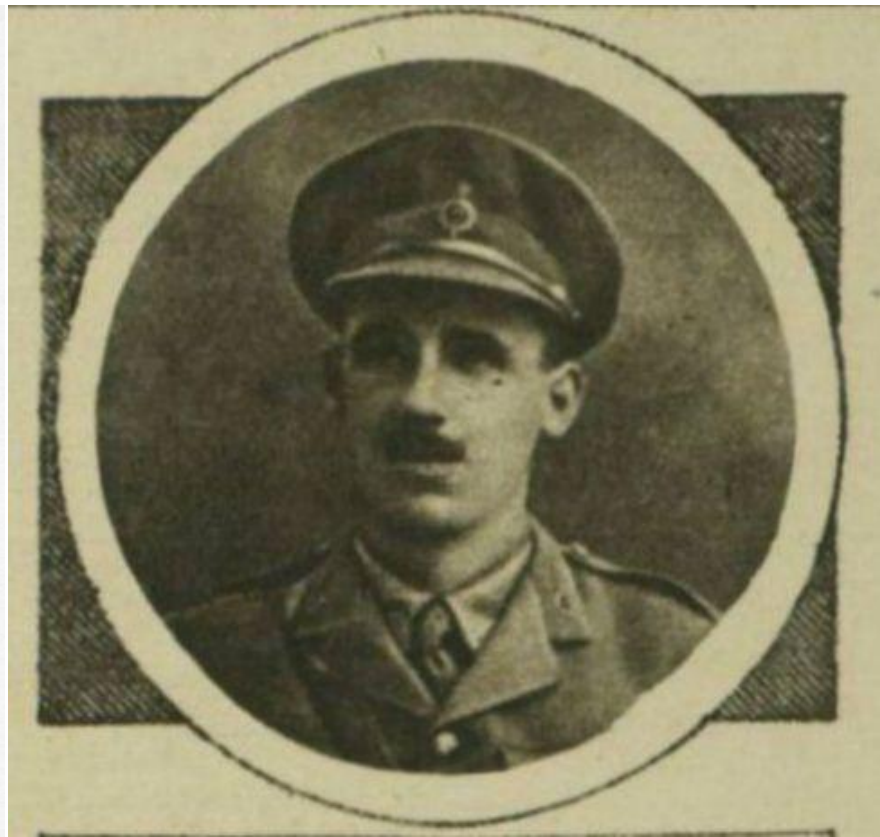
Jasper Muddock Photo #1 AI Enhanced



Jasper Muddock Photo #1 original



Jasper Muddock Photo #2 AI Enhanced



Jasper Muddock Photo #2 original

Notes and Clippings

From the Centenary issue of the Lyonian, researched by pupils 2014	
Muddock, J He died somewhere in France, unknown around December 1917. Before that, he was engaged in business in Burma.	
Correction - he did not die in France but in Palestine. The bit about Burma is correct.	

Biographical and military information from this website: <https://tinyurl.com/4yd4z8y6>

Jasper Milton Preston Muddock 2nd Lieutenant Shropshire Yeomanry Killed in Action 30 November 1917 Aged 29 Jasper Milton Preston Muddock was born on 25 May 1888 at Forfar, Forfarshire, Scotland, the son of James Edward Preston Muddock, Journalist and Author and Eleanor Muddock (nee Rudd). After leaving Dunstable Grammar School Jasper lived in Burma for almost 6 years but returned to England in 1914 to enlist as Private 3651 with the Inns of Court OTC at Berkhamstead. On 18 August 1915 he was commissioned a 2nd Lieutenant in to the 1st Shropshire Yeomanry, stationed at Flixton, Suffolk. The Battalion sailed for Egypt on 4 March 1916 and took up Suez Canal defence duties. A reorganisation in March 1917 put Jasper into 74th Division where he saw action in April in The Second Battle of Gaza. Promoted to Lieutenant in July 1917 Jasper was in action again at the Third Battle of Gaza and the action to capture Jerusalem when he lost his life. In the fighting along the Gaza-Beersheba line, the British lost a total of 18,000 killed, wounded, and missing.

Bolton Evening News, 8/12/1917

Mr. J. E. Preston Muddock, "Dick Donovan," the novelist, has been officially informed that his remaining son Jaspar Milton, a second lieutenant in the Yeomanry, was killed in action in Palestine on November 30th. Mr. Muddock has now lost all his three sons in the war.

Bolton Evening News, 8/12/1917

Mr. J. E. Preston Muddock, "Dick Donovan," the novelist, has been officially informed that his remaining son Jaspar Milton, a second lieutenant in the Yeomanry, was killed in action in Palestine on November 30th. Mr. Muddock has now lost all his three sons in the war.

mission in April, 1915.

Second Lieutenant JASPER MILTON PRESTON MUDDOCK, Yeomanry (killed in action on an Eastern front), was the last surviving son of Mr. J. E. Preston Muddock (Dick Donovan). The well-known novelist has now lost all his three sons in the war. Second Lieutenant Muddock went to the East with his regiment two years ago, and had seen a great deal of active service. He was educated at Dunstable Grammar School and Lower School, Harrow. When the war broke out he was in Burma, in the service of Bulloch Brothers and Co., where he had been for five and a half years, and during that time was attached to the Rangoon Mounted Rifles. Previous to leaving England he was in the 3rd Middlesex Sharpshooters. He returned home in the spring of 1915, and went through the Inns of Court O.T.C., and was drafted into the — Yeomanry. He was much interested in Burma and the Burmese, and he spoke Hindustani, Bengali, and Persian. As a soldier he had distinguished himself, and was greatly beloved both by his brother officers and men. His death at the age of twenty-nine cuts short a promising career.

Major NORMAN BETHUNE ROBERTSON, D.S.O., Royal

Morning Post, 8/12/1917 — mentions Lower School Harrow

mission in April, 1915.

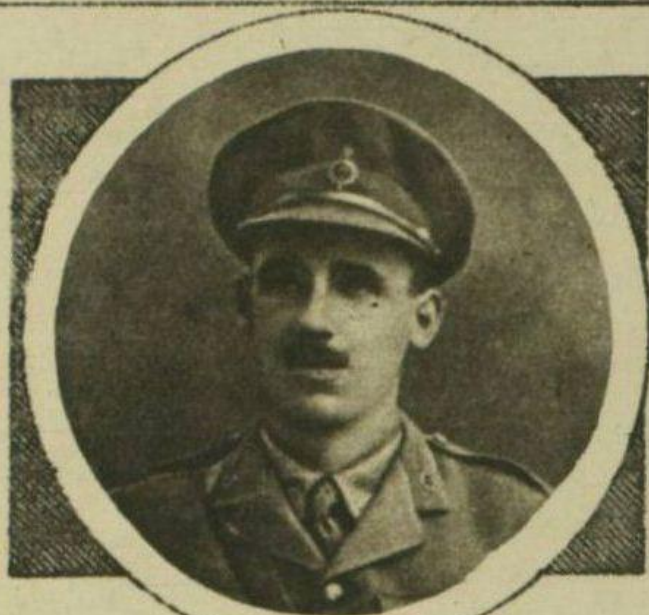
Second Lieutenant **Jasper Milton Preston Muddock**, Yeomanry (killed in action on an Eastern front), was the last surviving son of Mr. J. E. Preston Muddock (Dick Donovan). The well-known novelist has now lost all his three sons in the war. Second Lieutenant Muddock went to the East with his regiment two years ago, and had seen a great deal of active service. He was educated at Dunstable Grammar School and Lower School, Harrow. When the war broke out he was in Burma, in the service of Bulloch Brothers and Co., where he had been for five and a half years, and during that time was attached to the Rangoon Mounted Rifles. Previous to leaving England he was in the 3rd Middlesex Sharpshooters. He returned home in the spring of 1915, and went through the Inns of Court O.T.C., and was drafted into the — — — Yeomanry. He was much interested in Burma and the Burmese, and he spoke Hindustani, Bengali, and Persian. As a soldier he had distinguished himself, and was greatly beloved both by his brother officers and men. His death at the age of twenty-nine cuts short a promising career.

Sunday Mirror, 9/12/1917



Second Lieutenant J. M. Preston Muddock, last surviving son of Mr. J. E. Preston Muddock (Dick Donovan), who has been killed in action.

Second Lieutenant J. M. Preston Muddock, last surviving son of Mr. J. E. Preston Muddock (Dick Donovan), who has been killed in action.



2ND LIEUT. JASPER M. P. MUDDOCK,
Shropshire Yeomanry Son of Mr. J. E.
Preston Muddock ("Dick Donovan"),
the novelist.

2ND LIEUT. JASPER M. P. MUDDOCK,
Shropshire Yeomanry Son of Mr. J. E.
Preston Muddock ("Dick Donovan"),
the novelist.

"Dick Donovan's" Loss.

There will be much sympathy with the veteran novelist, Mr. J. T. Preston Muddock, in the loss of his third and last son on the battlefield. Mr. Muddock, as a servant of old "John Company," had his own experiences of war during the Indian Mutiny; and he saw active service again in America during the Civil War. As a novelist he has written historical romances under his own name, and at the same time has won great popularity as a writer of detective stories under the pseudonym of "Dick Donovan." Bismarck, by the way, was a great admirer of the "Donovan" yarns. Notwithstanding that he is by no means a young man he has been doing "war work" in Whitehall, for many hours a day, I believe, since the beginning of the war.

A Chance for Collectors.

"Dick Donovan's" Loss.

There will be much sympathy with the veteran novelist, Mr. J. T. Preston Muddock, in the loss of his third and last son on the battlefield. Mr. Muddock, as a servant of old "John Company," had his own experiences of war during the Indian Mutiny; and he saw active service again in America during the Civil War. As a novelist he has written historical romances under his own name, and at the same time has won great popularity as a writer of detective stories under the pseudonym of "Dick Donovan." Bismarck, by the way, was a great admirer of the "Donovan" yarns. Notwithstanding that he is by no means a young man he has been doing "war work" in Whitehall, for many hours a day, I believe, since the beginning of the war.

Pampering the Murderers.

Mr. J. E. Preston Muddock, better known as "Dick Donovan," writes to the "Daily Mail" as follows:—

On Wednesday evening last I was officially informed that my third and last son has given his life for his country in Palestine. On Thursday morning I was on duty as a special constable during the air raid, and in my neighbourhood a mother and two children were bombed to death. On Friday I read with a feeling of boiling indignation that the murderers taken red-handed were treated to cigarettes and coffee in a sergeants' mess.

As a broken-hearted father weeping for his dear dead, and in the name of my poor broken-hearted wife and sorrow-bowed daughters, I protest against this pampering of brutal murderers. It is an insult and an outrage to us whose dead have died that our country may live.

"Dick Donovan" puts the matter so admirably, that any comment on our part would be superfluous.

The Globe, 13/12/1917 Letter from Mr Muddock

Pampering the Murderers.

Mr. J. E. Preston Muddock, better known as "Dick Donovan," writes to the "Daily Mail" as follows:—

On Wednesday evening last I was officially informed that my third and last son has given his life for his country in Palestine. On Thursday morning I was on duty as a special constable during the air raid, and in my neighbourhood a mother and two children were bombed to death. On Friday I read with a feeling of boiling indignation that the murderers taken red-handed were treated to cigarettes and coffee in a sergeants' mess.

As a broken-hearted father weeping for his dear dead, and in the name of my poor broken-hearted wife and sorrow-bowed daughters, I protest against this pampering of brutal murderers. It is an insult and an outrage to us whose dead have died that our country may live.

"Dick Donovan" puts the matter so admirably, that any comment on our part would be superfluous.

From Lives of the First World War,
<https://livesofthefirstworldwar.iwm.org.uk/lifestory/3156551>

1917



DEATH Killed in Action Jasper was in action in April in The Second Battle of Gaza and again in November losing his life at the Third Battle of Gaza during the offensive to capture Jerusalem. Third Battle of Gaza Egypt [Source:7375444](#)

[Source:8611749](#)

30TH NOVEMBER 1917

WAR PENSIONS, &c., STATUTORY COMMITTEE.								
Establishment No.	NAME.	Rank, Name and Regiment of Officer.	Private Income and Date of Birth.	Attorneys, Assignees, &c.	Date of		Rate per Annum, £	Rate per Quarter.
					Authority.	Commence- ment.		
18355 955	Muddock. James Edward Preston & Eleanor. (Payable to Mr J. E. P. Muddock) 69 Nightingale Lane, Clapham Common SW 12.	2nd. Lieut Jasper Milton Preston Muddock Shrop. Ico. T.F.	2. 7. 7. £290. £210: - 2. 7. 7. nil		1918 12/12/18	1917. 1 Dec.	60	15.
			28 May 1843.					

Probate 1918 to confirm date of death and in this case father's name

MUDDOCK Jasper Milton Preston of Rangoon **Burmah** second-lieutenant Shropshire Yeomanry died 30 November 1917 in Palestine Administration **London** 4 April to James Edward Preston Muddock journalist. Effects £157 18s. 8d.